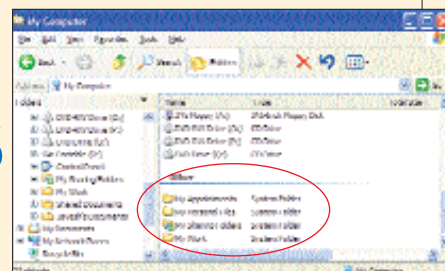


How can you create a folder like My Documents—one that will appear as a system folder in XP?

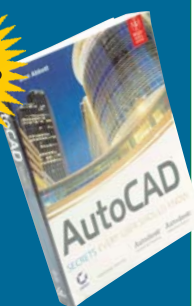
Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Create A Special Folder In Windows Explorer



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

Auto CAD

by Dan Abbott

Published by



LAST MONTH'S WINNER

Diptangshu Mandal
Palam Colony,
New Delhi

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

■ Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

▶ Create A Bootable XP CD That Pre-installs Additional Programs

Last month's solution

This month we had two people sending in the correct solution, and we chose the winner by tossing a coin. Here is the winner's solution; it involves using Windows Unattended CD Creator (WUCC), which was distributed with our December 2006 CD / DVD.

To create a bootable XP CD that preinstalls additional programs, first install WUCC. You need to have Microsoft .NET Framework 2.0 or higher installed.

When you open WUCC, you will be asked for the Windows CD or the directory of the Windows install files (the CD must be bootable). To add these files, click Select. After adding the install files, select a target directory for the new Windows CD (or you can modify the source directory provided it is not read-only). If you going to “Select target directory”, then it is better to use a new directory rather than an existing one.

The target directory will be a temporary location the software will use to create your disc image.

disc image. After you create your disc, you can delete this directory.

Now,
you can
add
Windows
hot-fixes
like those

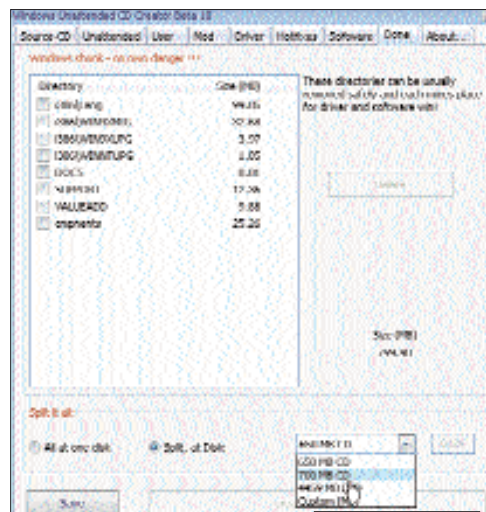
to Internet Explorer, WMP, DirectX, etc. Find these in the Hotfixes tab. Click the Select button to import the .exe files. When you select one, it will ask for a short name in 8.3 format, like “Explorer.exe”. After confirming the name, click Add.

Change to the Software tab. Here you add the software you want to install along with the Windows installation. Provide a name for the software in the Software Description box. Then “Select” the software type (Files Only or Directory). You’ll see that the files are being added to the program list. Click a program from the list and then click Select to enter

the program's start parameters (basically, the path from where it will be installed). Repeat this for every program in the program list.

The start parameter is like “%CDROM%\Software\...” If you don’t want to copy the programs to the Windows CD, click the checkbox titled **“Install directly from...”**, but when you repeat the step where you provide the start parameters, you must type a valid source path. Change the default “%CDROM%\Software\...” to the actual path, say: “C:\My Software\...”

When all your programs have been provided with their start parameters, switch to the Done tab. Here you'll see the list of directories that will be included in the Windows CD. If the size of the disc you've made is larger than the disc size (usually 700 MB), you can delete unnecessary directories, or you can split the files according to the disc size. You can also use a DVD.



The Done tab—where you can even select the media

Finally, click “Create ISO-image” to create the image for the new Windows bootable CD. Write this image onto a disc. You can now delete the temporary folder (the target directory in the “Source-CD” tab) you created.

The other solution was provided by Mr Pradeep Bishnoi, congratulations! His solution used a software called nLite.■